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Abortion pill access preserved for now

Mass. providers remain vigilant after court ruling

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

The Supreme Court on Thursday for now preserved access to the abortion pill mifepristone by mail and telehealth, delivering a temporary victory to Massachusetts providers while allowing the legal challenge to the practice to work its way through the courts.

In a 7-2 decision, the high court blocked a lower federal appeals court ruling that would have prohibited mailed prescriptions and instead reinstated the pre-pandemic requirement for dispensing mifepristone in person.

Abortion providers in Massachusetts in particular were hanging on the court's decision as they have become a key source of the medication for people in states that have restricted abortions following the overturning of Roe v. Wade in 2022.

Dr. Angel Foster, a physician with Cambridge Reproductive Health Consultants, said it felt like she was "sitting on pins and needles" waiting for word from the court, which came shortly after 5 p.m.

"The ban on mifepristone through telemedicine was never about safety. It was about controlling people's bodies and lives," said Foster, whose nonprofit serves a significant number of telehealth patients through the

ABORTION, Page A7

In a changed political climate, Markey quiet on Green New Deal

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When he faced a stiff primary challenge in 2020, Senator Ed Markey bet his career on a soaringly ambitious package of climate bills with a catchy name.

The Green New Deal, Markey's signature policy in Washington, was the core of his winning pitch against then-representative Joe Kennedy III. In his closing campaign ad, the senator even boastfully branded himself the "Green New Dealmaker."

Six years later, however, the Green New Deal is looking more like a piece of vintage Markey memorabilia than a campaign centerpiece. As he seeks his third full term this year, facing another primary challenge from a Democrat, Markey has stopped campaigning on, or even really mentioning, the marquee climate package that he did so much to popularize.

Strikingly, after introducing the original Green New Deal resolution in the Senate in 2019, and reintroducing it in 2021 and 2023, Markey did not put the legislation forward in this session of Congress.

On his campaign website, Markey lists 36

MARKEY, Page A6

This time, unions not so high on Healey



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE
Governor Maura Healey greeted members of the North Atlantic States Regional Council of Carpenters in Boston last month.

Tension over AI, MCAS, reining in health costs

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey rose to the governor's office four years ago on the backs of labor. She rallied alongside unionized teachers, and often recounted stories of her family's own deep labor roots. Even in deep-blue Massachusetts, she united workers behind her in unusual shows of support.

Now, some of her once most fervent supporters question if they recognize the person they helped put in office.

As Healey seeks a second term, some labor officials have taken umbrage with her administration's perceived embrace of artificial intelligence in state government, her opposition to a labor-backed ballot question targeting the MCAS exam, and messaging that leans heavily toward business, not labor interests.

A number of the state's biggest umbrella unions have yet to hand out their endorsements,

even as Healey faces little, if any, competition for their support. They include the Massachusetts Teachers Association, the Massachusetts Nurses Association, and the SEIU Massachusetts State Council, all of which endorsed her four years ago.

While Healey is likely to ultimately earn a slate of labor endorsements over one of her Republican opponents, it will come weighed down by behind-the-scenes tension and a lack of enthusiasm among many labor folks for a reelection bid that's largely become a referendum on

UNIONS, Page A6

'I couldn't sleep because I was scared the fire would come back.'

DAYANIRE MÉNDEZ, *who was able to reopen her day-care business*

Uprooted but undaunted

Community pitches in to help 44 displaced by fire in Lowell neighborhood



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Dayanire Méndez, shown with her daughter Deborah, said the exterior of their home was heavily damaged.

By Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

LOWELL — Dayanire Méndez's home day-care center on Wachusett Street was bustling with toddlers last Tuesday when, around 3:30 p.m., she felt an intense heat start to spread. She turned to her kitchen window and saw "too much fire." Her backyard shed was burning down as neighboring properties were engulfed by flames.

"The only thing [on my mind], the children," Méndez said. "Take care of the children, and go outside."

She and her older daughter, Sarah, scooped up the five children in her care — including Sarah's younger sister, Deborah — and

rushed out the front of the house, where police were calling on residents to evacuate. They took refuge in a neighboring home where "in 30 minutes, every father picked up their baby," Méndez said.

It's been more than a week since high winds and dry conditions carried a fire across four blocks and burned six homes on May 5 in the Centralville neighborhood, permanently displacing 44 residents and disrupting the lives of their neighbors and the city as a whole.

Méndez reopened her day-care business on the following Monday, a relative return to normalcy.

Local nonprofits are helping families with clothing, food, and other essentials, and had

raised nearly \$18,000 as of Wednesday. Overall, 10 families — 30 adults, 14 children — were uprooted.

"A number of them have come through with their children [and] their chins are up," said David Aldrich, cofounder of Project Compass, a nonprofit that has provided donations for the families.

None of the families will be able to return to their homes, according to Community Teamwork Inc., a local nonprofit providing families with housing assistance. Others in Lowell, like Méndez, are recovering amid the debris after the catastrophic fire.

Three days after the fire, one street over

FIRE, Page A7

Xi warns Trump of a possible clash over Taiwan



BRENDAN SMIALOWSKI/POOL VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

President Trump was full of praise for Xi Jinping, calling him a "great leader."

By Will Weissert
and Aamer Madhani
ASSOCIATED PRESS

BEIJING — China's Xi Jinping warned President Trump on Thursday that their two countries could clash over Taiwan if the issue is not handled properly, an unusually harsh admonition that stood in contrast to the American leader's praise for his counterpart.

The exchange at a highly anticipated summit in Beijing underscored just how far apart Trump and Xi still are on thorny issues, including the war in Iran, trade disputes, and Washington's relations with Taiwan, which is self-ruled but which China claims as part of its territory.

It also suggested that Trump's three-day visit to China is likely to be longer on pageantry and symbolism

than substantive political or economic breakthroughs.

The pair met for about two hours behind closed doors at the Great Hall of the People after an elaborate welcome ceremony featuring booming cannons, a band playing "The Star-Spangled Banner" and China's national anthem, and hundreds of schoolchildren jumping and waving flowers and American and Chinese flags.

According to a post on X by Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Mao Ning, Xi told Trump that "the Taiwan question is the most important issue in China-US relations."

"If it is handled properly, the bilateral relationship will enjoy overall stability. Otherwise, the two countries will

CHINA, Page A5

The suspect in the Memorial Drive shooting pleaded not guilty from his hospital bed. **B1.**

Economic news is bad but the stock market is soaring. Larry Edelman tells you why. **B5.**

Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates separately carried out strikes on Iran in retaliation for attacks during the war in the Middle East. **A3.**

The Red Sox lost again, but most of the other AL teams are struggling too. **C1.**



Danks a lot

Friday: Showers early. High 53-58. Low 48-53.

Saturday: Heating up. High 72-77. Low 59-64.

High tide: 10:31 a.m., 10:45 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:23 Sunset: 7:59

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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